

md2pdf

Converts a Markdown file to PDF via pandoc + XeLaTeX.

Requirements

- Bun
- pandoc
- A TeX distribution providing xelatex (default engine)

Debian/Ubuntu

```
sudo apt install pandoc texlive-xetex texlive-fonts-recommended
```

macOS

```
brew install pandoc && brew install --cask mactex
```

Setup

```
cd tools/md2pdf
```

```
bun install # no npm deps; installs the bun shim only
```

Global install

```
cd tools/md2pdf
```

```
bun link
```

Registers md2pdf at ~/.bun/bin/md2pdf. Add that to PATH if needed:

```
export PATH="$HOME/.bun/bin:$PATH"
```

Usage

PDF written alongside the input file

```
md2pdf document.md
```

Explicit output path

```
md2pdf document.md out/document.pdf
```

Custom engine, margin, font size

```
md2pdf document.md --engine lualatex --margin 2cm --font-size 12
```

System font (xelatex/lualatex only)

```
md2pdf document.md --mainfont "DejaVu Serif"
```

Keep the intermediate .tex for inspection or manual tweaking

```
md2pdf document.md --keep-tex
```

Open after conversion

```
md2pdf document.md --open
```

Options

Flag	Default	Description
<code>--engine <name></code>	<code>xelatex</code>	TeX engine: <code>xelatex</code> , <code>lualatex</code> , <code>pdflatex</code>
<code>--margin <size></code>	<code>1in</code>	Page margin; any LaTeX length (2cm, 15mm...)
<code>--font-size <pt></code>	<code>11</code>	Base font size in pt (6–72)
<code>--mainfont <name></code>	—	System font via fontspec (xelatex/lualatex only)
<code>--template <file></code>	—	Custom pandoc LaTeX template
<code>--keep-tex</code>	<code>false</code>	Preserve the intermediate <code>.tex</code> next to the PDF
<code>--open</code>	<code>false</code>	Open the PDF after writing

YAML front matter

Pandoc reads YAML front matter at the top of the Markdown file. Variables set there override any conflicting CLI flags.

```
---
title: "My Document"
author: "Name"
date: "2026-04-21"
geometry: margin=1in
fontsize: 12pt
mainfont: "DejaVu Serif"
---
```

```
# Introduction
```

```
...
```

Export the default template to customise the full LaTeX preamble:

```
pandoc -D latex > my-template.tex
# edit my-template.tex ...
md2pdf document.md --template my-template.tex
```